Mr. Wei's Chinese Class

Expanded HSK 2 Master Plan (Lessons 14-19) for Khaopan

Welcome to Version 2.0, Khaopan! In HSK 1, you learned how to declare basic variables and execute simple commands. In HSK 2, we are upgrading your logic engine. You will learn how to set system permissions (Can/May/Must), track state changes (Past/Completed), and write boolean comparisons (GreaterThan/LessThan). Let's initialize Phase 6.

Phase 6: System Permissions (Modal Verbs)

Lesson 14: Desire and Planning (想 vs 要)

The Concept (The "Why")

In English, we use "want" for almost everything. In Chinese, there are two levels of wanting, and they operate like different system priorities.

- **想 (*xiǎng*):** This is a low-priority process. It means "would like to" or "to miss/think about". It is a desire in your head that might not happen.
- **要 (*yào*):** This is a high-priority command. It means "to want/need to" or "going to". It signals intent and an upcoming action.

Varied Examples

Modal Verb	Chinese Sentence	Pinyin & Meaning
想 (Would like)	我想喝咖啡。	wǒ xiǎng hē kā fēi. (I *would like* to drink coffee.)
要 (Need/Going to)	我要去学校。	wǒ yào qù xué xiào. (I *need/am going* to go to school.)

Guided Walkthrough

Imagine you are designing a game logic loop for a character.
If the character has low HP, they don't just "feel like" healing; they *need* it.

Low priority: 我想吃苹果。 (I'd like to eat an apple — just a thought.)

High priority: 我要吃苹果。 (I want/need to eat an apple — I am going to get one now.)

Workbook 12: Priority Routing

1. Which verb represents a stronger intent/need: **想** or **要**?
2. Translate to English: **我想看书。**
3. Translate to English: **我要看书。**
4. What does **想** (*xiǎng*) mean besides "would like to"? (Hint: mental action)
5. Fill in the blank for strong intent: **今天我 ___ 去商店。** (Today I am going to the store.)
6. Translate: *wǒ xiǎng nǐ.*
7. Which modal verb would you use to order food at a restaurant?
8. Translate to Chinese: I want (need) to buy a computer.

Answers:

1. **要** (yào) | 2. I would like to read a book. | 3. I am going to read a book. | 4. To think / To miss

5. **要** (yào) | 6. I miss you. | 7. **要** (yào) | 8. **我要买电脑。**

Lesson 15: Abilities and Permissions (会 vs 能 vs 可以)

The Concept (The "Why")

English uses "can" for everything. In Chinese, "Can" is split into three distinct permission states.

- **会 (*huì*):** Can (because you learned how to do it). Like installing a software package.
- **能 (*néng*):** Can (because you have the physical ability or the circumstances allow it). Hardware capabilities.
- **可以 (*kě yǐ*):** Can/May (because you have permission). Admin access granted.

Varied Examples

- **Skill: 我会说汉语。** (*wǒ huì shuō hàn yǔ.*) = I can speak Chinese. (I learned it).
- **Ability: 我能吃十个苹果。** (*wǒ néng chī shí ge píng guǒ.*) = I can eat 10 apples. (My stomach is big enough).
- **Permission: 我可以看吗？** (*wǒ kě yǐ kàn ma?*) = May I look? (Do you give me permission?)

Guided Walkthrough

Let's debug a system error:

1. You know how to code in Python: **我会写代码。** (wǒ huì xiě dài mǎ).

2. But your laptop battery is dead, so the environment is down: **我不能写代码。** (wǒ bù néng xiě dài mǎ - I physically cannot right now).

3. Your mom says you have to sleep, so you don't have permission: **我不可以写代码。** (wǒ bù kě yǐ xiě dài mǎ).

Workbook 13: Permission Protocols

1. Which word means "can" through learned skill?
2. Which word means "can" through permission (may)?
3. Translate: **我会做饭。** (Hint: 做饭 = cook food)
4. Fill in the blank: The door is locked, so I ___ go inside. (会, 能, or 可以?)
5. Fill in the blank: I studied hard, so now I ___ read characters.
6. Translate: **我可以喝水吗？**
7. Translate: *wǒ bù néng qù.*
8. Translate to Chinese: I can speak Chinese (*hàn yǔ*).

Answers:

1. **会** (huì) | 2. **可以** (kě yǐ) | 3. I can cook (I know how). | 4. **不能** (bù néng)

5. **会** (huì) | 6. May I drink water? | 7. I cannot go (circumstances prevent me). | 8. **我会说汉语。**

Phase 7: State Tracking (Action Particles)

Lesson 16: The Completion Flag (了)

The Concept (The "Why")

Because Chinese verbs never conjugate, you cannot add "-ed" to a word to make it past tense. Instead, Chinese uses a state-change particle: **了 (*le*)**. When you place 了 after a verb or at the end of a sentence, it triggers a boolean state change: `isCompleted = true`.

Varied Examples

Action	Status	Sentence
买 (buy)	Ongoing/Future	**我买电脑。** (I buy a computer.)
买 (buy)	Completed	**我买了电脑。** (I bought a computer.)
去 (go)	Completed	**他去了学校。** (He went to school.)

Guided Walkthrough

Notice how Time words combine with the Completion flag:

Yesterday: **昨天** (*zuó tiān*)

Sentence: **昨天我吃苹果。** (Yesterday I eat apple - incorrect logic).

Correction: **昨天我吃了苹果。** (Yesterday I ate an apple - `isCompleted = true`).

Lesson 17: Database Logs (过)

The Concept (The "Why")

While **了** means an action was completed, **过 (*guò*)** is used to check your lifetime database logs. It means you have *experienced* something in the past. It translates to "have done" or "ever done".

Varied Examples

- **我去过中国。** (*wǒ qù guò zhōng guó.*) = I have been to China (experience).
- **我看过这个书。** (*wǒ kàn guò zhè ge shū.*) = I have read this book before.

Guided Walkthrough

Negating Experiences: If you want to say you have *never* experienced something, you must use **没 (*méi*)** because it is a check against past data.

我没去过中国。 (wǒ méi qù guò zhōng guó.) = I have never been to China.

(You *cannot* say **我不去过**. Error: Type Mismatch!).

Workbook 14: State Changes

1. What particle indicates an action is completed?
2. What particle indicates a past experience (have done)?
3. Translate: **昨天我买了手机。**
4. Translate: **我吃过苹果。**
5. Translate: *tā méi kàn guò.*
6. Fill in the blank: I went to school yesterday. (**昨天我去 ___ 学校。**)
7. Fill in the blank: I have never eaten this. (**我 ___ 吃过这个。**)
8. True or False: You use **不** to negate **过**.

Answers:

1. **了** (le) | 2. **过** (guò) | 3. Yesterday I bought a mobile phone. | 4. I have eaten apples before.

5. He hasn't seen/read it before. | 6. **了** (le) | 7. **没** (méi) | 8. False (You use 没).

Phase 8: Logic and Routing (Conjunctions)

Lesson 18: Because and Therefore (因为... 所以...)

The Concept (The "Why")

In programming, a `Try/Catch` block handles causes and results. In Chinese, we use the dual structure **因为** (***yīn wèi***) **...** **所以** (***suǒ yǐ***) **...** to express "Because... Therefore/So...". Unlike English where you usually only need one, Chinese prefers to wrap the entire logic statement using both.

Varied Examples

- **因为** (Because) **天下雨** (it rains), **所以** (so) **我不去** (I do not go).
- **因为我没有钱，所以我没买电脑。** (Because I don't have money, therefore I didn't buy a computer.)

Guided Walkthrough

Logic String: Cause -> Effect.

Cause: **我想学汉语。** (I want to learn Chinese.)

Effect: **我去中国。** (I go to China.)

Merged: **因为我想学汉语，所以我去中国。**

Lesson 19: The Comparison Operator (比)

The Concept (The "Why")

When writing an algorithm to sort items, you need a Greater Than (>) operator. In Chinese, the word **比** (***bǐ***) acts as this operator to compare two nouns.

Formula: Noun A + 比 + Noun B + Adjective (A is more [Adjective] than B).

Varied Examples

A	Operator	B	Adjective	Meaning
我 (I)	比 (bǐ)	他 (He)	高 (tall)	I am taller than him.
今天 (Today)	比 (bǐ)	昨天 (Yesterday)	热 (hot)	Today is hotter than yesterday.

Workbook 15: Logical Routing

1. What does 因为 (*yīn wèi*) mean?
2. What does 所以 (*suǒ yǐ*) mean?
3. Translate: 因为下雨，所以我在家。 (下雨 = rain)
4. Which word acts as the comparative operator ("than")?
5. Translate: 他比我高。 (高 gāo = tall)
6. Translate: 苹果比水好。 (好 = good)
7. Sentence Scramble: 我 / 高 / 比 / 爸爸 (My dad is taller than me. Hint: Dad > Me)
8. Fill in the blank: ___ 他没来， ___ 我不高兴。 (Because he didn't come, so I am unhappy.)

Answers:

1. Because | 2. Therefore / So | 3. Because it rains, so I am at home. | 4. 比 (bǐ)

5. He is taller than me. | 6. Apples are better than water. | 7. 爸爸比我高。 | 8. 因为 ... 所以